Similarly, other states such as Karnataka[3] and Kerala[4] too set up oxygen audit panels in hospitals so that irresponsible oxygen wastage could be avoided.

Oxygen rationing wasn't a new, unheard-of concept in the global medical community. Ever since the pandemic hit the world, it was clear that to combat a virus that mainly affects human respiratory systems, oxygen would be a life-saving commodity. In the first week of January, the US had a record number of daily hospitalizations which required explicit rationing of oxygen, medical supplies and ICU beds. Authorities in several high caseload districts, for instance, the Los Angeles Emergency Medical Services Agency instructed emergency responders to limit the use of supplemental oxygen and just deny transporting patients who don't seem like they could be revived.[5] The Mayor of London too, had then warned, 'One in 30 Londoners now has coronavirus. We will run out of beds for patients in the next couple of weeks unless the spread of the virus slows down drastically. The occupancy of hospital beds is nearing 100%.'[6] The Alpha variant (B.1.1.7) seemed to have caused the vertical ascent of cases in the recent weeks and several media reports demonstrated the intense pressure that this kind of an explosion put on UK's National Health Service.[7] Just earlier in the year, two of Brazil's largest cities—Sao Paulo and Manaus—ran out of oxygen.[8] However, when Union Minister Piyush Goyal advised that state governments should ration oxygen and keep a check on demand-side management as the GoI worked to keep up and improve the supply,[9] there was an outcry. The Opposition's network went berserk, almost catatonic over Goyal's comment as if it was absolutely unheard of. Senior Congress leader and former Chief Minister of Madhya Pradesh Digvijaya Singh retorted, 'How stupid Piyush ji!! Oxygen demand is need based. How can it be kept in control? From day one all Doctors were saying that the only treatment of COVID-19 is through O2 supply. GOI failed to plan for emergency. As they have failed on all fronts to deal with COVID-19 virus.'[10] So much for intelligent political discourse in civil, parliamentary language!

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Just like when the virus was hitting us in March 2020, the prime minister had held video conferences with influential groups like radio jockeys, folks